



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Grandma tells me all kinds of things!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What types of things do you or did you ask your grandparents?
- How is asking another relative about things different from asking your parents?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can talk about what happened and what had happened.
- I can explain the sequence of events.





Let's Explore!

Her grandson is **precocious***

* "Precocious" means advanced for their age.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

My grandson has always been precocious and inquisitive. Last year when I visited, he had just started kindergarten. He was learning about the past and asked question after question. His teacher had asked his class to find out about their family that week. He grilled me that weekend in a polite, but persistent way.

I had just sat down for a nice cup of tea on Saturday before breakfast when he made himself comfortable on the sofa next to me. He had sat there contemplating for a bit while he sipped some hot chocolate. His first question caught me off guard and after that he went on relentlessly. I wanted to laugh but didn't dare.

"How old are you Gamma?" he dove in.

"Quite old, but not really old yet", I parried.

"Were there cars when you were little?" he went on.

"Yes, dear, there were. Our family always had a car."

"What about phones and internet?" he asked pointedly.

"There were phones," I countered, "but only at home. We didn't have cell phones and there were no computers except at universities. They weren't like the ones we have today."

He had obviously wondered about these things. He had made a mental list of things to ask about before he commenced. He wanted answers and evidently felt that I, the oldest of the clan, could best supply them. At that point I got up and found the laptop. I opened it and looked for a timeline.

There we sat through several cups of tea, toast and cereal. When we dispensed with my life, we had gone on to looking at the changes in the earth. Then we tackled modern gadgets and appliances - things he was familiar with.

He was shocked and amazed. He found it difficult to understand how anyone could live without a fridge, a stove or an air conditioner. I often wonder that myself.





Let's Practice!

The grandson is very persistent with his questions.

Instructions: Choose the words and phrases from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

Dare / question caught / parried / Quite old / grandson / relentlessly / asked question / kindergarten / persistent / wanted / grilled

1. Last year my _____ had just started _____.
2. He was learning about the past and _____ after question.
3. He _____ me that weekend in a polite, but _____ way.
4. His first _____ me off guard and after that he went on _____.
5. I _____ to laugh but didn't _____.
6. " _____, but not really old yet", I _____.



Let's Practice!

Grandma is going through her life with her grandson.

Instructions: Write the correct form of the verb in parenthesis. Choose between Past Perfect and Simple Past.

1. The boy _____ (to ask) a lot of questions because the teacher _____ (to ask) the class to find out about the family.
2. I _____ (to sit) down for a cup of tea when he _____ (to make) himself comfortable on the sofa.
3. Before the teacher _____ (to give) the assignment the boy _____ (to wonder) about those things.
4. He _____ (to make) a mental list of things to ask about when he _____ (to start) to ask all the questions.





Extension Activity

Read a children's story aloud.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Get an English children's story (about 300 words) from the library or find one online.
- Read through the story and look up any new words or idioms that you find.
- Practice reading the story aloud with feeling, intonation and pauses.
- Use different voices where necessary.
- Bring the story to class and read part of it aloud for other students.
- Get feedback on your reading.
- Listen to other students read and give them feedback.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I find a children's story online or at the library.

☐ ☐

I practice reading the story aloud with feeling, intonation and pauses.

☐ ☐

I read part of the story aloud to a partner or group.

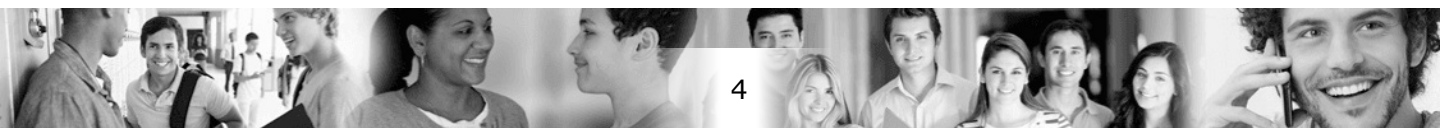
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I get feedback on my reading skills.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to ask question after question** (expression): to ask several questions one after another
e.g. He was learning about the past and asked question after question.
- relentlessly** (adverb): in a determined way
e.g. His first question caught me off guard and after that he went on relentlessly.
- kindergarten** (noun): the first year of formal education for a child
e.g. Last year when I visited, he had just started kindergarten.
- to grill** (verb): to ask a lot of questions for a long period of time
e.g. He grilled me that weekend in a polite, but persistent way.
- persistent** (adjective): in a determined but often unreasonable way
e.g. He grilled me that weekend in a polite, but persistent way.
- to dare** (verb): to be brave enough to do something
e.g. I wanted to laugh but didn't dare.
- to catch off guard** (expression): to surprise someone by doing something that they are not expecting or ready for
e.g. His first question caught me off guard and after that he went on relentlessly.
- to parry** (verb): to manage cleverly to avoid dealing with
e.g. "Quite old, but not really old yet", I parried.
- to counter** (verb): to react to something with an opposing opinion or action
e.g. "There were phones," I countered.
- to dispense with** (verb): to get rid of or stop using something or someone that you do not need
e.g. When we dispensed with my life, we had gone on to looking at the changes in the earth.





Learning Points

The Past Perfect vs. The Simple Past

You use both the Simple Past and the Past Perfect tenses to talk about past events. Sometimes you need or want to be precise about the order of events or emphasize which events happened before.

You use the Simple Past to sequence past events or actions.
You can use the Simple Past to put events in chronological order.

You use the Past Perfect tense to refer to an event out of order - to identify which event happened before the last event in the sequence.

Take a look at this example:

*I **called** Joe to thank him for the present he **had given** me last week.*

This sentence contains both the Simple Present and Past Perfect tenses.
Which event happened first? Joe had given me a present.
Which event happened next? I called Joe.

The form of the Past Perfect is:

subject + *had* + past participle

Examples:

- *Last year when I visited, he had just started kindergarten.*
- *His teacher had asked his class to find out about their family that week.*
- *I had just sat down for a nice cup of tea on Saturday before breakfast when he made himself comfortable on the sofa next to me.*
- *He had sat there contemplating for a bit while he sipped some hot chocolate.*
- *He had made a mental list of things to ask about before he commenced.*
- *When we dispensed with my life, we had gone on to looking at the changes in the earth.*

